

5 NIGHTS RWANDA PRIMATES CORNER_PREMIUM

The People - Nyungwe Forest - The Gorillas



OVERVIEW

Murakaza neza! Welcome to Rwanda, a magical landscape of a thousand hills and a million smiling faces. With a size of 26,338 sqkm and currently close to 14million people of which 70% are below 30 years of age, Rwanda is known to be one of the safest and cleanest countries in the whole world and was ranked second by the World Bank in ease of doing business, where one can register a business in 48 hours. The local language is Kinyarwanda, and English and French are official languages. Etched into global consciousness by the brutality of the 1994 genocide against Tutsis, the social and economic repair that has occurred since is nothing short of miraculous, the country is stable and tourism a now key contributor to the economy.

Our Rwanda Primates itinerary encompasses some of the main iconic attractions Rwanda is famous for. From the contemporary city vibe of Kigali, the sparkling streets of the capital city which is the rapidly growing, into the southwest of the country, at the Nyungwe National Park, confirmed to be the source of River Nile and being a massive montane forest home to the famous 70 meter above the forest Canopy Walk-way and thirteen species of primates including chimpanzees, Ruwenzori colobus and L'Hoest's monkeys.

We shall explore the jewel in the jungle green crown of the country in which lies the majestic Volcanoes where populations of endangered mountain gorillas still roam, fiercely protected by passionate people, and attract discerning travellers from around the world.

DAY 1 – ARRIVE KIGALI

Arrive Kigali - **Please advise flight details**

Arrive at Kigali International Airport. Airport arrival / assistance with immigration and customs. Private transfer to your hotel; dinner is on your own.



Located on one of Kigali's most charming boulevards, the Retreat is a 20-room luxury boutique hotel set in the vibrant heart of Kigali, this luxury boutique hotel and spa offers easy access to all that is happening in this dynamic city.

Overnight at the Retreat (B) includes breakfast

DAY 2 – NYUNGWE NATIONAL PARK - CANOPY WALK EXPERIENCE

Breakfast & check out of the hotel.

Transfer for a 15min drive to the Kigali Airport and Embark on a 30min Helicopter ride to One & Only Nyungwe House. Arrive early afternoon on a hot lunch after checking in as you gear up for the afternoon Canopy Walk adventure. One & Only Nyungwe House offers an exclusive window to Africa's fascinating wildlife and culture.



In the afternoon, go explore the 70 meters above the Forest Canopy Walk-way with a bird-eye view of the Forest, experiencing unparalleled biodiversity, orchids, monkeys and more from high above the Forest. The hike/walk to the Bridge is about 45min one way, before you reach the bridge with a highest view-point of the Nyungwe Forest. Along the way, you will have a chance to view the other habitants of the forest such as multiple bird species, butterflies, etc.

Overnight at One & Only Nyungwe House (FB) Includes Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

DAY 3 – CHIMPANZEE TREKKING

Early breakfast to be ready by 5:00 AM (could be packed) and drive for approx 1.5hrs drive to Cyamudongo starting point on a mixed rough “African massage” road, through hillsides and tea plantations.

At the starting point, you will firstly be briefed by the Park Guide on your Chimpanzee track. You will be allowed 1 hour with these fascinating close-to-humans primates which unlike Gorillas, are faster and super tree climbers, hence one needs to be early in the forest in order to catch them when they are yet to be in deep forest and sometimes hard to see. After Chimps trekking you will have a remainder of the day at leisure by the beautiful Tea plantations of the Nyungwe House.



Overnight at One & Only Nyungwe House (FB) Includes Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

DAY 4 – KIVU BELT SCENIC FLIGHT TO VOLCANOES NATIONAL PARK

Breakfast and check out as you transfer on a 45min Helicopter over the mountains and Kivu Lake to the Volcanoes right at the Singita Kwironda Lodge. Arrive in time for lunch and check at the renowned Singita Volcanoes Lodge.



At Singita Kwitonda Lodge, the location is easily the best of the luxury lodges in the area, the property has a border with the wall of Volcanoes National Park. The views of the large volcanoes are breathtaking, which greet you every morning as you awaken.”

In the afternoon, you will visit the **Ellen Degeneres Campus for Dian Fossey fund**, a Research Center & Campus for Conservation historical background and efforts by the famous Dian Fossey and the Volcanoes National Park safeguarding the endangered Mountain Gorillas. Providing a 3D visit to the Gorillas among other fun games to enhance your pre-encounter and knowledge about the magnificent and majestic mountain Gorillas!

Overnight at Singita Kwitonda Lodge (FB) Includes Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

DAY 5 – MEET THE LEGENDS: MOUNTAIN GORILLA TREKKING

After an early breakfast you will be driven to Volcanoes National Park, where you will join a group briefing at 7:00AM before your Gorilla Track. After the briefing you will be driven to the trailhead where your track begins (porters are available to assist at this point).

Tracking usually takes from 3 to 6 hours both ways. Once you come to one of over 13 habituated families, you will spend the allowed one hour with your Gorilla group as they go about their daily life; Silverback leading the way, while the mother is busy looking after the little ones and on the other side, sibling black backs (juveniles) fighting to show off. A definite once in a lifetime experience!



Afterwards, trek back to base where your guide will be waiting to take you to the lodge for lunch. Afternoon you may choose to enjoy an optional community village experience by the property, just as you may choose to relax at the Lodge with optional Spa and Massage treatment at the lodge. **Overnight at Singita Kwitonda Lodge (FB) Includes Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner**

DAY 6 – TRACE THE TRAITS: SECOND GORILLA TREKKING - DEPART RWANDA

After an early breakfast you will be driven to Volcanoes National Park, going through the same procedures before driving to the trailhead where your second day track begins (porters are available to assist at this point). This time a different Gorilla group!

At your second Gorilla trek, as always the high point will be spending an hour with gorillas and this time you will learn even more about these gentle giants. Indeed a more than a one-time visit is worth it!



Afterwards, trek back to base where your guide will be waiting to take you to the lodge for lunch and embark on a 25min Helicopter transfer back to Kigali International Airport.



And that will mark the End of your Rwanda Tour.